

Chapter 1 example

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1. Product Recommendation (Most Famous Application)

Problem

Customers have millions of products to choose from.

How does Amazon decide what to recommend?

Data Used

- Purchase history
- Search history
- Cart items
- Product ratings
- Browsing history

Data Science Solution

Recommendation System

Example

If you buy

- Laptop
- Mouse
- Keyboard

Amazon recommends

- Laptop bag
 - USB Hub
 - External Hard Disk
-

2. Fake Reviews Detection

Problem

Some sellers post fake positive reviews.

Example

A mobile phone receives

* * *

500 reviews in one day.

Is that genuine?

Data Science Solution

Machine Learning detects

- Repeated review patterns
- Similar review text
- Suspicious user accounts
- Unusual rating behavior

Result

Fake reviews are removed.

3. Demand Forecasting

Problem

How many iPhones should Amazon store next month?

Too many

↓

Warehouse cost increases.

Too few

↓

Products become unavailable.

Data Science Solution

Predict future demand using

- Previous sales
- Festival seasons
- Weather
- Holidays
- Current trends

Result

Optimal inventory.

4. Inventory Management

Problem

Which warehouse should store which products?

Example

Umbrellas

Need more stock

- Kerala
- Mumbai

Need less stock

- Rajasthan

Data Science predicts regional demand.

5. Delivery Time Prediction

Problem

Customers ask

“When will my package arrive?”

Data Used

- Distance
- Traffic
- Weather
- Driver location
- Previous delivery times

Output

Estimated delivery time.

6. Route Optimization

Problem

Delivery agent has

50 packages.

What is the shortest route?

Data Science Solution

Optimization Algorithms

Result

- Less fuel
 - Faster delivery
 - Lower cost
-

7. Fraud Detection

Problem

Some people

- Use stolen credit cards
- Create fake seller accounts
- Place fraudulent orders

Data Science detects

- Unusual spending
 - New login locations
 - Multiple failed payments
 - Suspicious transaction patterns
-

8. Dynamic Pricing

Problem

Should Amazon sell a TV for Rs. 50,000 or Rs. 48,500 today?

Data Used

- Competitor prices
- Demand
- Stock availability
- Festival offers

Price changes automatically.

9. Customer Churn Prediction

Problem

Some Prime members stop renewing subscriptions.

Can Amazon predict this?

Yes.

Data Used

- Shopping frequency
- Login history
- Time since last purchase

Amazon then offers

- Discounts
 - Coupons
 - Prime offers
-

10. Warehouse Automation

Problem

Amazon warehouses contain millions of products.

Where should robots place products?

Data Science decides

- Storage location
 - Picking order
 - Robot movement
-

11. Return Prediction

Problem

Some products are frequently returned.

Example

Shoes

Reason

Wrong size.

Amazon predicts

Products likely to be returned.

Result

- Better recommendations
 - Lower return costs
-

12. Personalized Advertising

Problem

Should Amazon show you

- Laptop ads
- Mobile ads
- Books

Data Science learns your interests.

13. Voice Assistant (Alexa)

Problem

Understand spoken language.

Example

“Alexa, play Telugu songs.”

Uses

- Speech Recognition
 - Natural Language Processing (NLP)
 - Machine Learning
-

14. Image Search

Problem

Customer uploads a dress photo.

Amazon finds similar dresses.

Uses

Computer Vision and Deep Learning.

15. Sentiment Analysis

Problem

Amazon has millions of reviews.

No human can read them all.

Example Review

“Battery is excellent but camera quality is poor.”

Data Science identifies

- Positive opinions
- Negative opinions
- Common complaints

Summary Table

Business Problem	Data Science Solution
Which products should be recommended?	Recommendation System
Fake reviews	Fraud Detection & NLP
How much stock is needed?	Demand Forecasting
Where should products be stored?	Inventory Optimization
When will the package arrive?	Delivery Time Prediction
Best delivery route	Route Optimization
Fraudulent transactions	Fraud Detection Models
Product pricing	Dynamic Pricing
Customers leaving Prime	Churn Prediction
Product returns	Return Prediction
Customer reviews	Sentiment Analysis
Voice assistant	NLP & Speech Recognition
Image search	Computer Vision

Step 1:

“Imagine our college principal asks us to identify students who are likely to fail/ no placed before the semester exams/ final year so that extra coaching can be arranged.”

Can we directly build an AI model?

No.

Then ask:

“What should we do first?”

Problem

↓

Data

↓

Prediction

↓

Action

Now say:

“This journey from a problem to a working solution is called the Data Science Project Lifecycle.”

Step 2: Solving a Mystery

“A Data Science project is like solving a detective case.”

The detective doesn't immediately arrest someone.

He follows steps.

Similarly,

A Data Scientist follows stages.

Stage 1: Define the Goal

Ask:

“What exactly is our problem?”

Example

College wants

“Predict students who may fail / don't placed.”

Wrong Goal

Improve education.

“How will you measure that?”

Nobody knows.

Correct Goal

Predict students with **90% accuracy** at least **one month before exams/ befor final year**.

Explain

Without a clear goal,

- we don't know what data to collect
- we don't know when to stop
- we don't know if the project is successful

Your textbook stresses that project goals should be **specific and measurable**, rather than vague statements like “we want to get better.”

Stage 2: Collect and Manage Data

Ask

“What information is needed?”

Attendance

Marks

Assignments

Lab performance

Hostel

Previous SGPA

Write

Attendance

↓

Internal Marks

↓

Assignment Marks

↓

Previous Results

↓

Student Dataset

“If attendance is missing for half the students, can we build a good model?”

No.

Explain

This stage includes

- collecting data
- cleaning data
- removing duplicates
- filling missing values

The book notes that this is often the **most time-consuming stage** and includes data exploration and cleaning before analysis.

Stage 3: Build the Model

Now ask

“We have the data.

What next?”

Machine Learning

Explain

Now we train algorithms like

- Decision Tree
- Random Forest
- Logistic Regression
- Neural Networks

Example

Input

Attendance = 40%

Internal = 15

Assignment = 10

Prediction

High Risk of Failure

Tell them

The computer learns patterns from previous students.

Stage 4: Evaluate the Model

Ask

“If my model gives only 45% accuracy,

Can the college trust it?”

No.

Now explain

We evaluate using

- Accuracy
- Precision
- Recall
- Confusion Matrix

Simple example

Out of

100 students

Actual failures = 20

Model predicted

18 correctly

Accuracy

90%

Recall

18/20

Show

Actual

↓

Prediction

↓

Compare

↓

Is model good?

Stage 5: Present Results

“Who should understand the results?”

Students

Principal

Faculty

Parents

Correct.

Don't show Python code.

Show

Current Failure Rate

↓

18%

↓

After Prediction System

↓

8%

This is what management wants.

We should understand different audiences need different presentations: business stakeholders want business impact, while end users need guidance on how to use the model.

Stage 6: Deploy the Model

Ask

“Suppose our model works.

Now what?”

Students

Use it.

Exactly.

Deployment means

Putting the model inside

- College ERP
- Mobile App
- Website

Now whenever attendance becomes low

System automatically alerts

Warning

Student 203

High Risk

The model is now helping real users.

The chapter further explains that after deployment, the model must be monitored and updated as conditions change.

Explain Iteration (Very Important)

Draw

Goal

↓

Data

↓

Model

↓

Evaluation

↓

Deployment

Then draw a curved arrow back.

Say

“Suppose accuracy is only 55%.

Do we deploy?”

No.

“What should we do?”

Collect more data.

Improve model.

Exactly.

Data Science is **not a straight line**.

It is a cycle.

The chapter’s lifecycle diagram emphasizes these feedback loops between stages.

Another Example

Netflix Movie Recommendation

Stage	Netflix Example
Goal	Recommend movies users will enjoy
Data	Watch history, ratings, search history, watch time
Build Model	Recommendation algorithm
Evaluate	Did users click and watch the recommendations?
Present	Business report showing increased watch time
Deploy	Recommendations appear on every user’s home screen